group of **18-29** years doing **moderate work** and weighing **60 kg**. Similarly, an **Indian woman 18-29** years old doing **moderate work** and weighing **55kg** is referred to as the Reference woman.

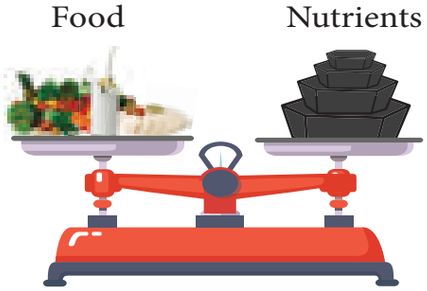
The RDA is based on scientific knowledge and prepared by the National Nutritional Advisory Committee (ICMR). The Committee revises the RDA every 10 years. The current RDA for Indians was set up in 2010. The recommended dietary allowances for Indians (2010) is given in table 1.1

1.2 BALANCED DIET

A **"Balanced Diet"** can be defined as **one which contains different types of foods in such quantities and proportions that the need for calories, minerals, vitamins, and other nutrients is adequately met and a small provision is made for extra nutrients to, withstand short durations of leanness.**

A balanced diet should provide around 50-60% of total calories from carbohydrates, 10-15% from proteins and 20-30% from both visible and invisible fat.

In addition, a balanced diet should provide bioactive phytochemicals such as dietary fibre, antioxidants and other nutraceuticals which have positive health benefits.



Different food in the right amount and proportion provide all essential nutrients and thus make a balanced diet

Fig. 1.2 Balanced diet

Balanced Diet enhances the quality of life as it:

- meets nutritional requirement
- prevents degenerative diseases
- improves longevity
- prolongs productive life
- improves immunity
- increases endurance level
- develops cognitive ability
- helps in coping up with stress

Points to be considered in planning a balanced diet

- Calorie allowances can be ± 50, while for all other nutrients minimum RDA must be met.
- Energy from cereals should not be more than 75 percent.
- Include two cereals in one meal e.g. rice and wheat.
- To improve protein quality the ratio of cereal protein to pulse protein should be 4:1.
- Two to three serving of pulses should be taken a day.
- Include at least one medium size fruit. The fruit can be given raw without much cooking.
- Five servings of fruits and vegetables should be included in a day
- The diet should include minimum 100ml milk per day.
- Foods rich in fibre should be included.
- One-third of the nutritional requirements, at least calorie and protein should be met by lunch and dinner.

Unit 1 RECOMMENDED DIETARY ALLOWANCE AND MEAL PLANNING.indd 5 1/19/2020 2:51:01 PM